CLASS 7 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 6: **The Rise of Empires** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which is more probable for the Mauryan decline? 1

(a) multiple causes over time **(b)** one battle
(c) one flood **(d)** one plague

2. Why does the Arthashastra advise a strong treasury? 1

(a) to build tombs
(b) to hide wealth
(c) to pay army and officials and support welfare
(d) to buy gold

3. A Greek account refers to 'Sandrocottus'. Historians identify him as 1

(a) Chandragupta Maurya **(b)** Ashoka
(c) Dhana Nanda **(d)** Bindusara

4. Which of the following would a historian need to verify the claim that Ashoka's empire stretched to Karnataka? 1

(a) a folktale **(b)** a poem
(c) a painting **(d)** location of edicts and findspots

5. Which of these best describes Ashoka's dhamma in modern terms? 1

(a) trade treaty **(b)** ethical code promoting harmony
(c) military doctrine **(d)** taxation policy

6. Why did Ashoka continue to maintain an army after Kalinga? 1

(a) to fight Alexander **(b)** to protect the empire and keep order
(c) to trade **(d)** to conquer

7. The Mauryas' use of a common currency such as punch-marked coins helped 1

(a) farming **(b)** war
(c) tax avoidance **(d)** trade within the empire

8. Why might a ruler record his regret publicly, as Ashoka did? 1

(a) to start wars
(b) to hide events
(c) to set an example and justify the change in policy
(d) to show weakness

9. **Assertion (A):** Ashoka's edicts were mostly written in the Devanagari script. 1
Reason (R): Brahmi was the script used in most of Ashoka's edicts.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** Pataliputra, the capital of the Mauryas, is now Patna. 1
Reason (R): Pataliputra lay on the banks of the river Kaveri.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did Ashoka show religious tolerance? 2

12. Why was Taxila important? 2

13. Why was Pataliputra well placed? 2

14. What is the significance of Ashoka's lions? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Examine how the Mauryans managed a vast empire. 3

16. Analyse the factors leading to the empire's fall. 3

17. Evaluate the status of women in Mauryan sources. 3

OR

Discuss the economic basis of the Mauryan state. 3

18. Discuss the cultural achievements of the Mauryan period. 3

OR

Discuss why Ashoka is considered a model ruler. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** Megasthenes, the Greek ambassador, lived at Pataliputra and described the city, the king and the army in a book called Indica. The Arthashastra, a text linked to Kautilya, lists seven elements of a state (saptanga), including the treasury (kosha) and the army. 5
(i) Who was the Greek ambassador at the Mauryan court?
(ii) What did kosha mean in the saptanga?
(iii) What was the name of his book?
(iv) Why are such records useful for a historian studying the Mauryas?

20. Evaluate the contributions of Kautilya and the Arthashastra to political thought. 5

OR

Evaluate the Mauryan Empire's contribution to the idea of a welfare state. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks